

used a Greek text that leaned heavily on Codices Vaticanus and Sinaiticus. But decades before, Herman C. Hoskier had published his *Codex B and its Allies, a Study and an Indictment* (London: Bernard Quaritch, 2 volumes, 1914). He demonstrated objectively that the named codices are not good copies. The RSV committee obviously ignored Hoskier's work. I would say that whoever wrote the RSV preface was lacking in integrity. The alleged 'accumulated errors' were merely a smokescreen to deceive the reader and to defend their use of a radically different Greek text, a text that incorporates errors of fact and plain contradictions, as well as hundreds of serious changes. I would say that anyone who still believes the allegations contained in the quote from the RSV preface is in fact embracing **canards**.

Evaluating the 'basic principle'

Anyone who studies NT textual criticism will encounter the following statement: The basic principle of textual criticism is: choose the reading that best explains the rise of the others (or something similar). The uninitiated reader probably will not discern that the statement depends on certain presuppositions (that might be fallacious). Textual criticism only exists for texts whose original wording is deemed to be 'lost'. No one does textual criticism on today's newspaper, or last week's news magazine. No one even does textual criticism on the 1611 King James Version, since we still have printed copies thereof. Anyone familiar with the terrain knows that for the last 140 years, or so, the academic world has been dominated by the notion that the original wording of the NT text is in fact 'lost'. That notion is based squarely on Hort's theory. That theory denies: 1) that the NT writings were divinely inspired; 2) that the early Church recognized them to be Scripture; 3) that they received any special care or protection. As a result, by the time that the superstition and credulity of the Christians had elevated the NT writings to the status of 'Scripture', the original wording was irrevocably 'lost', in the sense that no one knew what it was. Therefore, so goes the theory, it is impossible to recover the original wording by using objective criteria; so they appeal to subjective criteria. (It should be obvious to any thinking person that this places the critic above the text. Notice, further, that there is no way of knowing if they have found it.)

The notion that the original wording of the NT text is 'lost' rejects (or at least ignores) the historical evidence that shows that the transmission of the NT writings was basically normal, from the beginning. That notion also rejects the vast majority (90-95%) of the extant NT manuscripts that